Shipping Charges – How We Stop Losing Money

Prepared for Sudeshna · Bhoomija · October 2026

1. The problem in one line

Our website charges shipping by the product's weight, but Shiprocket charges by the size of the box as well. For light but big items (lamps, planters, figurines) the box is what costs money – so we under-charge the customer and pay the difference.

Real example – Order #BMJ1004 (lamp to Mumbai):

	Amount
Lamp actual weight	0.675 kg
Box size used	≈ 8.9 kg "volumetric" weight
Customer paid for shipping	₹160
Shiprocket charged us	₹451
Loss on this one order	≈ ₹290

2. How couriers actually charge

Every courier calculates two weights and charges the higher one:

Weight	How it is calculated
Dead weight	What the packed box weighs on a scale
Volumetric weight	Length × Breadth × Height (cm) ÷ 5000
Chargeable weight	Whichever of the two is higher

Example: a 26 × 26 × 28.5 cm box = 3.85 kg volumetric, even if the lamp inside weighs only 0.33 kg. If we enter a smaller size than the real box, the courier re-measures at the hub and deducts the difference from our Shiprocket wallet.

3. Our plan – two simple changes

Step	What we do	Why
A. Box weight on website	For each product, set its Shopify weight = the chargeable weight of the box it ships in (not its bare weight).	So the website knows the "real" shipping weight and picks the right price slab.
B. New price slabs	Update the shipping charges per weight band to match real Shiprocket costs (table in section 5).	So what the customer pays covers what we pay.

Small items (jewellery, pouches, stoles, coasters) hardly change. Only bulky items move to a higher slab.

4. What we tested

a) Real Shiprocket rates – 14 products, from our pickup (Kolkata 700029) to Mumbai and Kolkata, using a fitted box (product size + 5 cm padding on each side).

Product	Chargeable wt	Kolkata (cheapest)	Mumbai – Blue Dart	Mumbai – Ekart*
Tikuli pen stand	0.56 kg	₹84	₹156	–

Product	Chargeable wt	Kolkata (cheapest)	Mumbai – Blue Dart	Mumbai – Ekart*
Maa Kali figurine	1.6 kg	₹87	₹309	₹309
Black Tikuli tray	2.3 kg	₹124	₹386	₹309
Red Jamdani lamp	3.85 kg	₹161	₹616	₹309
Tagore clay sculpture	4.3 kg	₹197	₹692	₹309
Lord Shiv & Maa Durga	6.9 kg	₹264	₹1,076	₹309
Big Giraffe planter	10.1 kg	₹289	–	₹415
Ek Chaala Maa Durga	15.6 kg	₹418	–	₹597

* Ekart's service to Mumbai starts at 7 kg and costs a flat ₹309 up to that level. Any parcel from about 1.5 kg up can be booked as 7 kg on Ekart – booking a higher weight is allowed; only under-declaring is penalised.

b) Website checkout test – we set up the new slabs on 3 products in a temporary test, checked checkout (stopped before payment), then removed the test. All 8 checks matched.

Product (test weight)	Mumbai	Kolkata
Pen stand (0.56 kg)	₹160 ✓	₹130 ✓
Red Jamdani lamp (3.85 kg)	₹330 ✓	₹280 ✓
Big Giraffe planter (10.1 kg)	₹450 ✓	₹420 ✓
Pen stand + lamp together (4.4 kg)	₹330 ✓	₹280 ✓

5. Proposed shipping charges (for your approval)

Order weight	West Bengal	Rest of India	North-East & J&K;
0 – 0.5 kg	₹90	₹95	₹130
0.5 – 1 kg	₹130	₹160	₹180
1 – 2 kg	₹160	₹330	₹400
2 – 7 kg	₹280	₹330	₹400
7 – 12 kg	₹420	₹450	₹540
12 – 20 kg	₹420	₹650	₹780

Changes from today are only for orders above 1 kg. West Bengal stays almost the same (we already cover cost there). North-East is estimated ~20% above Rest of India and still needs one rate check.

6. Which courier to choose – important

Courier prices differ a lot for bulky parcels (4 kg box to Mumbai: Ekart ₹309 · DTDC ₹403 · Blue Dart ₹692). The website charges above assume we pick the cheapest option:

Parcel (chargeable weight)	Book as	Courier
Up to 1.5 kg	Actual weight	Cheapest shown (often Blue Dart / Amazon)
1.5 – 7 kg	7 kg	Ekart 5Kg (~₹309) or DTDC
Above 7 kg	Actual weight	Ekart / DTDC 10 kg

In Shiprocket always: (1) enter the real box size and weight, (2) set Dangerous goods = No (the lamp was wrongly flagged – that is why only one courier appeared), (3) sort by price low to high. Use Blue Dart for big parcels only if the customer needs speed.

7. Packing rules for the team

• Use the smallest box that fits safely – every extra cm costs money.

• Weigh and measure the packed box; take a photo of it on the scale (proof if Shiprocket raises a weight dispute).

• Enter the real L × B × H and weight in Shiprocket – never less.

• Fold textiles flat; take lamps apart where possible.

• Paintings without frame: ship rolled in a tube (much cheaper than a box).

8. What we need from you

#	Decision / input
1	Approve the new shipping charges in section 5 (or tell us your preferred numbers).
2	OK to always pick the cheapest courier for bulky parcels (Ekart / DTDC)?
3	Packed box size for lamps and other bulky items (or approve our suggested fitted sizes).
4	Any items you would rather absorb shipping on (add part of it to the product price instead)?

Once approved, we update the rates and the shipping weights of bulky products, test checkout again, and confirm.